þ. Initially, medially when doubled, and finally **þ** was a voiceless spirant like the **th** in NE. **thin**, as **þencan**, *to think*; **þēof**, *thief*; **moþþe**, *moth*; **bæþ**, *bath*; **mūþ**, *mouth*. Medially between voiced sounds, it was a voiced spirant like the **th** in NE. **then**, as **baþian**, *to bathe*; **brōþor**, *brother*; **eorþe**, *earth*; **fæþm**, *fathom*.

Initial **þ** was written **th** until about 900 in imitation of Latin. Afterwards it was written **ð**, and **þ** (borrowed from the runic alphabet). And the voiced spirant was often written **d** in imitation of the contemporary Latin pronunciation.

w does not occur in OE. manuscripts, but was represented by **uu**, **u** until about the year 900, later by **ƿ** borrowed from the runic alphabet. It had the same sound-value as the **w** in NE. **wet**, as **wæter**, *water*; **sweltan**, *to die*; **wlanc**, *proud*; **sāwol**, *soul*.

x was pronounced like the **x** in NE. **six**, as **rīxian**, *to rule*; **siex**, *six*; **weaxan**, *to grow*; **āxian**, *to ask*.

§ 8. From what has been said above we arrive at the following OE. consonant-system:—

		Labial.	Inter-dental.	Dental.	Guttural.	Palatal.
Explosives	Voiceless	**p, pp**		**t, tt**	**c, cc**	**c, cc**
	Voiced	**b, bb**		**d, dd**	**g, gg**	**g, cg**
Spirants	Voiceless	**f, ff**	**þ, þþ**	**s, ss**	**h, hh**	**h, hh**
	Voiced	**f**	**þ**	**s**	**g**	**g**
Nasals		**m, mm**		**n, nn**	**n**	**n**
Liquids				**l, ll; r, rr**		
Semi-vowel		**w**				

To these must be added the aspirate **h**, and **x**. The double consonants were pronounced long as in Modern Italian and Swedish, thus **habban = hab·ban**, *to have*; **swimman = swim·man**, *to swim*, see §§ **258–9**. From the above table it will be seen that the OE. alphabet was very defective, insomuch as each of the letters **c, f, g, h, n, s,** and **þ** was used to represent two or more sounds.